

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

EVALUATOR:

DATE:

PRODUCT:

TASK:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

No clear loading indicators when switching between Personal and Business views.

Recommendations

Add a subtle spinner or progress bar during view switching to confirm the action is processing.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

Some financial terms used may not be familiar to all users (e.g., "peak activity hours").

Recommendations

Use plain, real-world terms like "busiest hours" with icons for easier understanding.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

No confirmation prompt when editing profile or category settings. Users may lose data if they leave without saving.

Recommendations

Add a "Save Changes?" dialog before exiting any edit screen.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Back and exit buttons are not placed consistently across filter and settings screens.

Recommendations

Follow platform standards (e.g., back button always on upper-left corner) on all screens.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

No warning before deleting a category or filter preset.

Recommendations

Add a confirmation dialog (e.g., "Are you sure?") before any destructive action.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Dashboard charts require users to remember past activity to understand trends.

Recommendations

Use clear labels, legends, and visual summaries so users don't have to rely on memory.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

Filtering transactions takes multiple taps; no shortcuts for expert users.

Recommendations

Add quick filters (e.g., swipe gestures or preset buttons) for faster access.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

Profile settings screen has too many options crowded together.

Recommendations

Group related settings into collapsible sections or use a cleaner, spaced-out layout.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

Error messages (e.g., when saving profile changes) are not specific. Users see generic alerts without clear solutions.

Recommendations

Use plain language error messages that clearly state the problem and suggest a fix (e.g., "Please fill in all required fields before saving").

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

No in-context help available when users are filtering transactions or editing categories.

Recommendations

Add a small "?" icon or tooltip next to complex features so users can get quick help without leaving the screen.